Silverheights School Council Meeting Minutes

Date & Time: November 23, 2022, 6:30-8:30 pm

"Parents play a vital role in the development and education of their children and in the success of schools.
They are the most important influence in a child's life outside of school.
Long after direct learning from parents in a child's early years gives way to formal education, parents continue to play a key role in student success through the attitudes they help to share and the direct supports they provide."

Ontario Ministry of Education

School Council Summary: https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/school-councils/

School Council Handbook: https://www.wrdsb.ca/wp-content/uploads/school_council_chairpersons_handbook.pdf

Item	Agenda Item	Duration	Person(s) Responsible
1	**Welcome & Introduction** In-person Attendance: L. Tam., M. Thompson, H. Train, C. Moffat, J. Latour, T. Goudy, J. Stere, A. Chong, A. Pharoah Virtual: T. Kaippila, K. Davy, E. Ambachtsheer Regrets: K. Petznick., L. McCreight., Lori (SNA) Guests: Mr. Daines, Parents of Student Delegation (Ruby, Quincy, Curtis, Laura) • Approval of October Meeting Minutes: A. Chong, A. Pharoah)	5 mins	Chair (Ling Tam)
2	**News**		
	Student Delegation from Mr. Daines' Class - Why we need pizza day • See appended slide deck • Offer once a week, preferred on Tuesdays or Wednesday (already a "CARE" fundraiser) from Dec/Jan to end of school year • Announcement & online payment through School Day • Types: choice of cheese or pepperoni; halal option is the cheese • Preferred Vendor (historical vendor): Dominos • Estimated # pizzas per week for school = 62 large round (8 slices per pie) • Volunteers including parents & students • Student sign-up sheet for rotating duties for Gr5+, or one student from each class to pickup) • ACTION: Vote on action, update cost for 2023, confirm School-Day online payment	5 mins	Principal & Vice-Principal
	Community Partnership – Silverheights Neighbourhood Association www.silverheightsneighnourhood.com • Regrets. Refer to website & Facebook for current programs	5 mins	Community Rep (Lori Ryan-Da Cunha)

	Community Partnership – Mummy & Me • Deferred to next meeting	5 mins	Community Rep (Michelle Thompson)
	WRAPSC • See attachment to the agenda	5 mins	Assembly Rep
	PIC • See attachment to the agenda	5 mins	Assembly Rep
3	**Teacher's Report** • Int. intramurals (volleyball) is underway • Jr intramurals (soccer) is underway • In-class Remembrance Day celebrations in lieu of school assembly; provided more interaction • Bus evacuation drills completed • ACE team is active, including the coffee cart for staff. • Gr. 8 High school visit completed Nov 23 • Spirit "Super Me" Day on Nov 25 • Lock-down drill day last week went well. • Food drive completed at beginning of Nov. • Ms. Bonas "Gift of Giving" running Dec 5-9th, looking for volunteers (restocking, cash, wrapping). Second event planned in spring 2023. Students should have cash to pay for purchases. Individual parents/Council member can connect with FB group (free stuff). • Difficulty in recruiting parent volunteers – can parents of Gr. 7/8 swap volunteer duties? • Council discussed difficulties for recruiting volunteers that may background checks/vulnerable sector check (VSC, needed if teacher is not able to provide direct supervision). Must be completed through the Region of Waterloo Police online request. Valid for 12-mnths from date of issue. Fees apply & could be a limitation for volunteers. Can Council pay for the fees associated with these checks? Jason to confirm if Council is allowed to reimburse this cost. Perhaps Council can do a volunteer drive in Sept to reimburse costs if parents do their VBC at the beginning of the school year. ACTION: Send another announcement for donations on School Day needed. Add announcement to board at front of school. ACTION: Jason to look into policies if Council can pay for background/vulnerable check fees.	10 mins	Teacher Rep (Chad Moffet)
4	**Principal's Report** • Progress reports going out this week; updated format but content is similar to previous years • EQAO information delayed due to cyberattack & access to results. Parents encouraged to look at the EQAO website to view the results for the school. Note, results	10 mins	Principal (Jason Stere)

	are for a single cohort & mirror the data from progress reports from 2021-2022. Emphasis will continue to be early intervention of literacy, reading & math. A presentation can be prepared with the EQAO results for Jan 2023 meeting if requested. • Teachers Wish-List for Council funding: ○ Kindie Classroom:$1500 for learning materials ○ Field Trips: $5K to 7K for entire school to take one field trip this school year. Includes 1 trip per class (1 bus carries 2 classes; $250/bus rndtrip in town); All bus companies are private, not publically funded, cost of fuel & limited drivers has doubled the overall cost for busing. ○ Home Reading Program: $5K-7K to replenish well-used books. This program supplements the online PM shelf subscription & is based on reading level equivalency to supplement in-class readers; Primary grades but is expanded to all grades as needed. ○ Guest Speakers: $2K for 2 requests from Jr. & Int classroom. Select from board-approved list ○ STEM: $2K learning materials ○ Athletics: $1K ○ Clubs (D&D, GSA): $500 • Council asked about brining outside vendors/speaker into the school but there are liability issues that would have to be signed by the Principal (Jason). • Student surveys being completed, facilitated by teachers. Collected data to inform schools priorities. For students in Gr. 4+. Participation is encouraged but not mandatory.		
5	**Equity Connection** • 10 individuals participating the book club • Schedule for meets to start 3rd Thursday starting in January 2023 (total of 5 meets) • Books (to be purchased in Dec) is Council property. • Participants will have the choice to keep the book & pay for the book after book club concludes. • Returned books to be kept as teaching resource for staff or reserved for Council use for future book clubs (pending feedback). • Q: Is there the option of a virtual option to participate in the breakout discussions? A: Potentially. Tara to follow-up.	5 min	Vice-Principal (Tara Goudy)
6	**Financial Report** No change from October statement = $21,950 • These monies should be spent this school year, or at least be allocated for specific use. Grants: https://www.wrdsb.ca/wp-content/uploads/4690-School-Generated-	10 min	Treasurer

	Funds.pdf • See attached WRPSC notes for historical spends on grants PIC Grant Parents Reaching Out (PRO) Grant: https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/parents-reaching-out-pro-grants/		
7	**Council Subcommittees** In-school volunteers • See above notes from agenda item 3 (Teachers Report) on requirements for background/VSC & follow-up actions by Jason. Fundraising Committee • Pizza Days – see above notes from agenda item 2 Historically: • Multiple 6-8-wk sessions throughout the school year • Announcement & payment through School-Day • Spreadsheet output to determine # slices/class & pizza/class • Discounted price from Dominos (historically met Board-level nutritional content) • One parent volunteer needed for administrative work • 2-3 parent volunteers onsite from 12:45 – 2:15 pm to allocate pizza per class. This can be a rotating duty between roster of parent volunteers) • Student delegation to champion student recruiting effort. • Equity issue associated with families who are not about to purchase to be discussed. Option to top up cost per slice to provide pizza for families unable to pay. Other ideas? ACTION: Ling to share historical files from previous years. Establish subcommittee to organize: Alison, Amy, Heather, Kate, Treasure, Jenn, Erin A. VOTE: Approved by in-person & virtual members-at-large **Special Event initiatives – Deferred to Jan 2023 meeting** • Family movie nights • Smencil sales • Community Activity Fair	15 mins	Subcommittee Rep
8	**Calendar of Planned School Events**	5 min	Council Members
9	Questions & Answer Period	5 mins	Council Members
10	Next Meeting Date: NO COUNCIL MEETING IN DECEMBER Social for all council members on Dec 21 6:30 at Four Fathers Brewing Co.	January 25, 2023	In-person & online meet

11	Agenda Items for Next Meeting	5 mins	Council Members
12	Adjournment		

Notes:
MOE – Ontario Ministry of Education
PIC – Parent Involvement Committee (https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/)
PRO – Parents Reaching Out
SCIS – Safe, Caring & Inclusive Schools (https://www.wrdsb.ca/pic/links/safe-caring-and-inclusive-schools-scis-resources/)
WRAPSC – Waterloo Region Assembly of Public School Councils (https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/wrapsc/)

General Council Email: silverheightscouncil@gmail.com

WRAPSC Meeting Notes - November 2022

Coalition of Muslim women of KW (CMW)

- deal with islamophobia, racism (ie. anti-black, anti-asian, antisemitism, xenophobia)
- a reporting line to document hate incidences
- reporting line: purpose is to help the city understand the extent of violence within the community, which will lead to the development prevention programs and services. They also want to find out where it is taking place, to find out who has been impacted. For the victims: to access supports, to educate, to provide counselling referrals and mental health supports, and to provide a link to police services
- Education: deliver education sessions on hate, discrimination, racism, and active bystander training to school staff. Might also come to speak to school councils.
- Terms
    - Hate incidents: cannot be treated legally, but impactful to the victim
    - Hate crime: offense specifically designated in the Criminal Code of Canada with an aspect of hate: a hate-motivated crime (ie property damage and assault)
    - Hate speech: verbal, online, or print messaging that encourages hatred & may lead to personal threats
- School council suggestions regarding equity: ie. Halal marshmallows
- felt that there are simple compromises for school councils for pizza and fundraising
- coalition.ca/cw
- Home | Coalition of Muslim Women KW (cmw-kw.org)
- report@cmw-kw.org

Volunteer Waterloo Region (volunteerwr.ca)

- youth friendly volunteering site to provide students with volunteering opportunities
- Suggestions: teens volunteer individually or as a group with other students so that they can fulfill a longer commitment because some of their volunteering opportunities are for months
- they encourage a drop-in model for volunteering students that they can develop themselves

Best practices /Grants

- PRO grant: due beginning to mid Jan. 2023
- board wants the funds to be used to support the Strategic plan
- $500 annual parent involvement funding by the ministry for parent engagement. Council supposed to have a say in it, and it's on the principal's financial line. If it's not used, it disappears for that year.
- You can combine the $500 ministry Grant and the PRO grant together
  https://www.wrdsb.ca/our-schools/get-involved/parents-reaching-out-pro-grants/
    - Ministry Grant money info: $500 Annual Fund Memo – Parent Involvement Committee (ugdsb.ca)
    - Activities spent: Family Skating event, parent events and resources, speakers related costs, cyber safety workshops, merging the $500 with the PRO grant to put on bigger programs or activities including parents and the students, math night, school resources
    - Other ideas: an international dinner with foods from around the world, direct mailing to parents to ensure that all parents receive reliable information and understand about school council, a parent resource center (parent book lending library and other parent focused resources), social "meet and greet" aspect to school council/parent group meetings (15 minutes of refreshments and networking at the beginning), purchase advertising space in the local newspaper (Meet the Teacher night, parent focused events held at the school), an informal "breakfast/coffee with the school council," purchase transition to secondary school information/welcome package for

parents, design fridge magnets (with school contact info, important school dates like PD days, Meet the Teacher, school council meetings, and any other parent focused school events), etc.
- $500 Annual Fund Memo – Parent Involvement Committee (ugdsb.ca)
- Ideas on how to spend the funds: 2The Thames Valley Parent Involvement Committee has created a list of effective ways to use the $500 Base (ugdsb.ca)
- PROGrants2021_FAQ[9946].pdf
- 2021-11-01 WRAPSC Presentation PRO Grants (1)[9948].pdf
- https://www.hwdsb.on.ca/wp-content/uploads/2021/11/HWDSB-PRO-Grant-application-2021-2022-form.pdf

PRO regional grant: https://www.wrdsb.ca/wp-content/uploads/2020-21-PRO-Grant-Regional-Project-Summary.pdf

Other grants:

- Playground grant: Playground Grants and Funding in Canada | PlayQuest
- University of Waterloo engineers
- Environmental grant: School garden - Ontario Community Environment Fund | Ontario.ca
- WWF: for a nature space gardening
- Library grant: 2022 Indigo Love of Reading Literacy Fund Grant Program – Indigo Love of Reading Foundation

Fundraising

- Board Policy: 4017_Fundraising[9907].pdf

2020-2021 PRO INDIVIDUAL grant $500 or PARTNERED school PRO grants ($500 from each school)

- Well Being at Avenue Road - guest speaker to address well-being among families (Cambridge)
- Virtual Talk with Jeff Yalden
- Supporting Student Mental Health Workshop for Parents
- X Movement (Cambridge)
- Building Families' Capacity for Virtual Learning
- Cybersecurity in a Virtual Learning Environment - Binary Tattoo
- Beautify Courtyard at Coronation (Cambridge)
- Virtual Art and Talent Night
- Cooking with Courtland - Recipe book
- Parenting During a Pandemic Virtual Presentations - Sara Westbrook
- Nurturing Your Child's Emotional Well-Being - Sara Westbrook
- Parenting During a Pandemic Virtual Presentations - Sara Westbrook
- Nurturing Your Child’s Emotional Health - Sara Westbrook
- Fun for the family with an animal encounter (Cambridge)
- Mental Health and Covid - Understanding the Impact and What To Do
- Parent Community Engagement (Elmira District Secondary School)
- Online Safety Presentation - Paul Davis
- Online Safety Presentation - Paul Davis
- Cyber Security - Paul Davis
- Educating and Empowering Parents about Social Networking and Online Safety - Paul Davis
- Welcome Sign and Wall Mural (Cambridge)
- Wellness Workshops - Eric Bolton Music, Art Appreciation Workshop, Proactive Fitness
- Amalgamated Mother's Group - Partnered with Settlement Workers (SEPWR)

- Grade 11 Parent Information Session: Pathways to Life After High School (Jacob Hespeler SS)
- We Belong Together - tile puzzle piece
- Welcome to Jean Steckle PS - Meet and Greet outdoor signage
- Engaged and Supportive Online Parent Workshop
- STEM, Music and Motivational Speaker Virtual Sessions - partner ESQ University of Waterloo
- Learning Community — Alive & Well!
- Parenting in a Digital Age - Andrea Davis, betterscreentime.com, partnered Moffat PS & Trillium PS (Doon PS)
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- Virtual Magic Show/Virtual Parent Wellness Session
- Wood Tile Mural (Cambridge)
- Student Well-being and Mental Health
- Math Kits (Cambridge)
- Equity and Anti-Racism Speaker
- Resources, including books, encouraging Anti-Racism and Inclusiveness in Our Community
- Helping Students dealing with current situations arising from Covid-19 (Silverheights)
- New to Canada? Engaging immigrant parents
- Connecting with Our Community - Eric Bolton, local musician.
- Math Enrichment Night(s) - Tinker Truck
- Mother's Group - interpreter to share important school news and seek input from families
- Wellness Event for Students, Teachers and Families of Vista Hills
- Students and Screen Time
- Provide Enhanced Community Garden.
- https://www.wrdsb.ca/wp-content/uploads/2020-21-PRO-Grant-School-Councils-Applications-Summary.pdf
- noticed that our local elementary schools didn't apply for PRO grant: Hillcrest, Centennial, Hespeler, Woodland Park Public
- We might be able to combine our PRO grants like Moffat PS and Trillium did
- Noticed that the only high schools that applied for the PRO grant were Elmira District Secondary School & Jacob Hespeler Secondary School

Purpose: Purpose of school council: to improve pupil achievement in to enhance the accountability of the education system to parents

School By-law Examples:

- election of parent members during the first 30 days of the school year
- principal supposed to report on education in the province
- principal should use School Day to talk about school council
- School staff have a vote in certain matters in school council for example budget matters, but not in the election of members of the school council like the chair, secretary, etc.
    - School Council By-laws: https://www.ontario.ca/laws/regulation/000612#BK4
    - School council handbook will be updated; still good resource: rules

  https://www.wrdsb.ca/wp-content/uploads/school_council_chairpersons_handbook.pdf

PIC issues

- Only two novice PIC members this year, so WRAPSC will likely be pushing the agenda

- We will likely not see much activity coming out of PIC until their 4th meeting, which is near the end of the year

Equity Issues and Update on other Schools in our board

- Offering Halal pizza options
- Buy 2 tickets when you need only one; other ticket will be donated
- Freeze pizza to give to children in need
- Some schools are doing pizza; others are not
- School councils always include WEFI as a reminder for individuals to donate to their school; WEFI is on every agenda

School & Parent Issues:

- order of chain of command if a parent is concerned: teacher, vice principal, principal, superintendent
- trustees deal with school policies, can direct you to appropriate person though
- if school council is concerned and not moving forward with a principal, if it is serious, contact superintendent; info on board website; trustees are limited in this area

Mental Health:

- November Lunch and Learn WRDSB Psychology Department (free and don't need to sign up) https://www.wrdsb.ca/blog/2022/10/31/november-lunch-and-learn-sessions-for-parents-and-caregivers-2/
    - Helping Your child with Perfectionism: Nov. 23 @ 12:15-12:45
    - Tuning into Your Child: Ways to Form Meaningful Connection Nov. 30th @ 12:15-12:45

BEP (for Students Grades 7-12 and their Parents): https://www.bepwr.ca/initiatives/explore-your-future

- Dec. 7: Careers in Skilled Trades
- Jan 18: Health Minds and Bodies
- Feb. 8: Working with Numbers